Facilities requirements

For venues used to conduct driver licensing and endorsement courses

NZ Transport Agency Waka Kotahi

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Introduction

This facilities requirements document is based on a combination of:

- NZQA principles
- Health and Safety at Work obligations
- NZTA requirements for Vehicle Inspection facilities, accessibility principles, and
- accepted educational assessment practices

NZQA requires facilities to be safe, adequate for the programme being delivered, suitable for learners, and compliant with legal and health and safety requirements.

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1. Physical Environment

Room Size

The facility should:

- Be large enough to accommodate all learners undertaking training and/or assessment comfortably.
- Allow movement between desks without disturbing others.
- Allow assessors to supervise all participants in the room.

Recommended:

- Minimum 2.0 to 2.5 m² per learner.
- Additional space for assessors and mobility access.

Lighting

Good lighting allows learners to read printed material and screens without discomfort and accurately.

Minimum requirements

- Even illumination across the room.
- No glare on computer screens.
- No significant shadows.

Recommended standard

- Adjustable blinds to control sunlight at different times of the day and year.

Ventilation and Temperature

Facilities should maintain learner comfort and concentration.

Recommended

- Temperature between 18°C and 24°C.
- Adequate fresh air circulation.
- Mechanical ventilation where natural ventilation is insufficient.

Poor air quality and excessive temperature can significantly affect concentration and assessment performance.

Noise Control

Training and assessment activities require an environment with limited distractions.

Collaborative Training

- Background noise should permit normal conversation.
- Spaces should support small-group discussion.

Assessments

- External noise should be minimised.
- Learners should be able to hear assessment instructions clearly.
- Adjacent activities should not disrupt assessment sessions.

Recommendations

NZTA acknowledges these recommendations are wholly dependent on being built into the site being used for course instruction and assessment and may not be present in existing locations.

- Dedicated assessment rooms with acoustic separation.
- Acoustic ceiling panels or wall treatments where possible.

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2. Furniture and Seating

Training Activities

The space should support:

- Individual work
- Pair activities
- Group collaboration
- Classroom instruction

Recommended

- Moveable desks and chairs.

- Flexible room layouts.

Assessment Activities

Furniture must support independent work and minimize opportunities for collusion.

Recommended

- One learner per desk or larger desks supporting learning – for example a 'U' shaped arrangement of desks with even spacing between seats.
- Desks facing a common direction.
- Minimum 1 to 1.5 metres between learners where practical.
- Clear line of sight for supervisors.

Accessibility

Facilities should accommodate learners with disabilities.

This may include:

- Wheelchair-accessible paths.
- Height-adjustable tables.
- Accessible toilets.
- Hearing assistance technology where needed.
- Alternative seating arrangements.

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3. Digital Technology

Internet Connectivity

Where digital learning or testing occurs:

- Reliable broadband connection.
- Backup connectivity where possible.
- Adequate bandwidth for simultaneous users.

Computing Devices

Devices should:

- Be sufficient in numbers for all learners and be a consistent type (e.g. Android tablets)
- Support required software.
- Function reliably throughout testing.

For assessments:

- Devices should be reset between candidates.
- Access to unauthorized websites or applications should be controlled.

Audio-Visual Equipment

Training rooms should ideally include:

- Large display screen or projector.
- Screen visible from all seating positions (this is a must where used).
- Speakers.
- Webcam capability for remote participation – where applicable.
- Video playback capability.

Whiteboards

At least one of:

- Whiteboard – which must be visible to all learners
- Digital whiteboard.
- Flipchart.

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4. Assessment Security

This is particularly important for theory training and assessments.

Supervision

Assessment areas should allow:

- Continuous observation and visibility of all learners.
- Easy movement by assessors without disrupting learners.

Cheating Prevention

The facility should support:

- Physical separation between candidates.
- Secure storage for mobile phones and bags.
- Controlled entry and exit.
- Continuous observation and visibility of all learners.

Recommended

- Privacy screens between devices.
- Dedicated assessment rooms.

Assessment Materials

Facilities should include:

- Secure storage for assessment resources.
- Restricted access to completed assessments.
- Secure disposal of confidential material.

5. Learner Welfare Facilities

Toilets

Learners should have access to:

- Clean toilets.
- Handwashing facilities.
- Accessible toilets where required.

Recommended

- Toilet facilities within the same building or immediate vicinity.

Drinking Water

Provide:

- Drinking fountains or water dispensers.
- Access throughout training and assessment sessions.

Break Areas

For longer sessions:

- Separate break space.
- Seating.
- Access to refreshments where possible.

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6. Health and Safety

Emergency Management

Facilities should have:

- Emergency evacuation procedures.
- Clearly marked exits.
- Assembly point information.
- Fire extinguishers where required.
- First aid kit.

First Aid

At least:

- Accessible first aid supplies.
- Designated first aid contact.
- Incident reporting process.

Security

Facilities should provide:

- Safe access to the site.
- Appropriate lighting in parking and entry areas.
- Security measures where sessions occur outside standard business hours.

7. Driver Licensing-Specific Considerations

For facilities supporting driver licence training or assessment:

Vehicle Access

The site should have:

- Safe parking.
- Pick-up/drop-off area.
- Space for pre-drive vehicle inspections.

Testing Operations

For on-road assessments the route should provide access to:

- Low-speed roads.
- Urban roads.
- Intersections and roundabouts.
- Higher-speed roads where relevant.

Road Safety

Assessors should be able to:

- Brief candidates safely.
- Conduct vehicle checks safely.
- Record outcomes securely.

Suggested Minimum Standard Statement

The training and assessment facility must provide a safe, accessible, adequately lit, temperature-controlled environment with appropriate seating, digital technology, audio-visual equipment, sanitation facilities, emergency management arrangements, and assessment security controls. The facility must support both collaborative learning activities and independently supervised assessments that maintain assessment integrity and minimise opportunities for cheating.